TIDEWATER CLIMATE TRUST

2025

Annual Report — Holding the Line Where the Land Meets the Sea

OUR MISSION

We restore and permanently protect the salt marshes, oyster reefs, and tidal forests of the Meridian Coast — the living infrastructure that shields two hundred miles of communities from storms while drawing carbon into centuries-old mud.

6,140

Acres of salt marsh restored or placed under permanent easement in 2025 — our largest single-year total

18 mi

Of living shoreline constructed with partner towns, replacing failing bulkheads across four counties

$11.2M

Deployed into coastal projects, with 84 cents of every dollar going directly to restoration work

A Letter from the Executive Director

Dear friends of the coast — I write this from the observation deck at Half-Moon Sound, where five years ago we planted the first test plots of smooth cordgrass into what was then a drowned and eroding pasture. This October, a juvenile sturgeon was recorded in the restored channel for the first time in forty years. It is the kind of result that does not fit neatly in a spreadsheet, and the kind that explains every number that does.

2025 asked a great deal of this organization. Two named storms crossed the Meridian Coast within three weeks of each other in September. Our living shoreline sites — all eighteen miles of them — came through with repairable damage, while adjacent hardened shorelines saw four bulkhead failures. The comparison was not lost on the county commissions: three of the four affected towns have since signed restoration agreements for 2026.

We also closed the largest conservation transaction in our history, the 2,300-acre Pelletier Marsh easement, after a four-year negotiation. I want to thank the Pelletier family for choosing permanence over three competing development offers, and our land-protection team for the patience that made the choice possible.

Financially, the Trust ends the year stronger than it began. Contributions grew nineteen percent, our first federal resilience grant arrived on schedule, and the board approved a reserve policy that now covers seven months of operations. The figures at right are drawn from our audited statements, available in full on our website. On behalf of all forty-one staff — thank you for keeping faith with the slow, stubborn work of restoration.

— Dr. Camille Okafor, Executive Director, Port Meridian

FINANCIAL HIGHLIGHTS (AUDITED, IN THOUSANDS)

LINE ITEM	FY24	FY25	CHANGE
Contributions & grants	$8,940	$10,620	**+18.8%**
Government resilience awards	$1,275	$2,410	**+89.0%**
Program spending — restoration	$7,180	$9,405	**+31.0%**
Administration & fundraising	$1,610	$1,790	**+11.2%**
Operating reserve (months)	4.1	7.0	**+2.9**
Net assets, end of year	$14,320	$17,955	**+25.4%**